

KS3: EARLY MODERN WORLD & GLOBAL ENCOUNTERS (1450–1750)

Assessment Question: How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Source A: The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778)



A ceiling painting by Spiridione Roma (1778), originally commissioned for the Revenue Committee Room at East India House in London (now held by the British Library). It is an allegorical painting showing Britannia receiving jewels, spices, and silk from Asia, Africa, and India. It highlights the ideology and wealth of the empire.

Source B: Foreign Trading Factories at Canton (Guangzhou)



A reverse glass painting by an unknown Chinese artist (c. 1805) currently held by the Peabody Essex Museum. It depicts the highly regulated district in Qing China where European companies operated, proving that Asian empires held immense global economic power.

Source C: The Financial Hub of London



An engraving of the Second Royal Exchange in London by Wenceslaus Hollar (1644), now held by the Metropolitan Museum of Art. By 1750, London was crowded with merchant ships and transformed into the financial center of global maritime trade.

Source D: Nautical Planisphere World Map



A world map created by Flemish cartographer Gerardus Mercator in 1569. Early modern maps revolutionized travel by introducing new projections for navigation, showing the massive ocean trade routes and the terrifying scale of global exploration.

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Do Now	RAG	Effort	Level	WWW (What Went Well)	EBI (Even Better If)
Who held global power in 1450?	/ 5	○				
How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?	/ 5	○				
Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?	/ 5	○				
Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle	/ 5	○				
Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift	/ 5	○				
What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	/ 3	○				
How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	/ 3	○				
How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)	/ 4	○				
Final Unit Grade:						

L1: Who held global power in 1450?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450.
- ☐ Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth.
- ☐ Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.

Do Now: Connecting the Sources

Score: / 5

Look at the four historical sources depicted on the front cover of this workbook. What connections can you make between them, and what do they suggest about the balance of global power before 1450?

Q1. Why was the fall of Constantinople catastrophic for merchants in Western Europe? [p. 3]

Q2. Based on Source B, how does the reality of the Thirteen Factories in Canton challenge the idea that Europeans dominated global trade in the 1700s? [p. 4]

Q3. What impression do Sources D and E give about the balance of power between Europe and the rest of the world in the 15th century? [p. 5]

Q4. Class Debate: Based on Professor Frankopan's argument, why might traditional European textbooks have deliberately ignored the wealth of the East in 1450? [p. 6]

Q5. Lesson Reflection: Looking at the state of the world in 1450, why might a historian argue that Europe was actually on the periphery of global power rather than at its center? [p. 6]

Q6. How does the evidence in Source F and the description of the peasant's 'pottage' contrast with the lives of the Oba of Benin or the Ming Emperor? [p. 7]

Q7. Why does this evidence support the idea that Europe was an 'isolated outpost' in 1450? [p. 7]

Assessment Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the Ming Dynasty (China), the Islamic Empires (Ottoman/Mali), and the Silk Road.
- Sentence Starter: In 1450, the true centers of global wealth were...
- Sentence Starter: This was because they controlled...
- Sentence Starter: By contrast, Europe was relatively isolated because...

Q8. Explain why Europe was not the center of global wealth and power in 1450.

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General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517.
- ☐ Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly.
- ☐ Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What was the overarching name for the ancient trade network connecting Asia to Europe?

2. Which major empire expanded to block overland European trade routes in 1453?

3. What city was captured by Sultan Mehmed II in 1453?

4. What West African kingdom was known for its detailed bronze plaques in the 15th century?

5. Why did the capture of Constantinople force European nations to look for new trade routes?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Reformation | Privateer | Armada | Monopoly | Indulgences

Your Sentence:

Q1. Why did the Spanish attack Francis Drake and John Hawkins at San Juan de Ulúa despite having signed a truce? [p. 11]

Q2. How did Queen Elizabeth I use privateers as a strategic tool against Spain? [p. 12]

Q3. Describe the two main reasons the Spanish Armada failed to invade England. [p. 13]

Q4. How does the author's perspective in Source C differ from Source B regarding Francis Drake and the conflict? [p. 13]

Q5. What message was the artist of the Armada Portrait trying to convey about England's future? [p. 14]

Q6. How does the revisionist view (Perspective B) challenge the traditional view (Perspective A) of the Armada's defeat? [p. 14]

Q7. Lesson Reflection: To what extent did the Protestant Reformation act as the primary catalyst for European expansion and global exploration during the 16th century? [p. 14]

Q8. Why might history textbooks prefer to focus on the 'glory' of Francis Drake rather than the reality of scurvy? [p. 15]

Q9. How did the Protestant Reformation push England into global exploration and conflict with Spain?

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Teacher Comment:

L3: Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion.
- ☐ Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India.
- ☐ Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. In what year did Martin Luther post his 95 Theses?

2. What name was given to English sailors, like Francis Drake, who were given legal permission to attack Spanish ships?

3. What was the name of the Spanish King who launched the Armada against England in 1588?

4. What weather event destroyed much of the fleeing Spanish Armada off the coast of Scotland?

5. Why did Queen Elizabeth I use privateers instead of the Royal Navy to challenge Spain in the Americas?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **Joint-Stock Company**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

Q1. Why was Matoaka brought to the court of King James I in London? [p. 18]

Q2. How did the funding of early English colonial expansion differ from the Spanish model? [p. 19]

Q3. What was the primary motivation stated in Source B for colonizing Virginia, and why might the Virginia Company emphasize religious duty over profit? [p. 19]

Q4. Using Source C, explain why the East India Company was forced to act politely toward Mughal rulers in 1616, whereas English settlers in Virginia acted aggressively toward Native Americans. [p. 19]

Q5. What does the design of the Jamestown Fort suggest about the relationship between the English settlers and the local indigenous population? [p. 20]

Q6. How do Perspective A and Perspective B disagree on the origins of the British Empire? [p. 20]

Q7. Lesson Reflection: Based on the early encounters between Europeans and indigenous populations, how did initial trade relationships gradually transform into systems of imperial control and exploitation? [p. 20]

Q8. How does this 'ground-up' detail change our understanding of why Native Americans became hostile to the Jamestown settlers? [p. 21]

Q9. Explain how the creation of the East India Company (EIC) transformed British trade.

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General Notes

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Teacher Comment:

L4: Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze why **King [Key Individual: King [Key Individual: King Charles I]]** and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651).
- ☐ Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth.
- ☐ Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What was the name of the first permanent English settlement in North America (1607)?

2. Which cash crop saved the Jamestown colony from economic ruin?

3. What type of business model was the East India Company (EIC), where multiple investors pooled money?

4. Which powerful Asian empire did Sir Thomas Roe visit in 1615?

5. Why were the English submissive traders in India, but aggressive conquerors in North America?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Contextual Cloze

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Divine Right of Kings | New Model Army | Commonwealth | Plantation | Navigation Acts

King Charles I believed in the _____, which angered Parliament. After losing the Civil War to the _____, the monarchy was abolished and replaced by the _____. Meanwhile, wealthy merchants who funded Parliament grew rich from Caribbean _____ slavery. They then passed the _____ to ensure all this wealth flowed directly into English ships.

Q1. How useful is this painting as evidence of Britain's global power and ideology in 1778? [p. 24]

Q2. Why was the execution of King Charles I such a shocking event in European history? [p. 26]

Q3. How did the Atlantic Merchants use their wealth to influence the outcome of the English Civil War? [p. 27]

Q4. How does Source C reveal a completely different reason for Parliament's victory over the King compared to the official reason given in Source B? [p. 28]

Q5. Look at Source D. What does Cromwell accuse MPs of becoming? Why is this ironic given that merchant wealth helped bring Cromwell to power? [p. 28]

Q6. Which historian argues that the conflict was primarily about political and class rights, and which argues it was about establishing the conditions for global capitalism and empire? [p. 28]

Q7. What radical belief did the Diggers hold about private property and the earth? [p. 29]

Q8. Why did wealthy Parliamentarians like Oliver Cromwell violently crush the Diggers? [p. 29]

Q9. Lesson Reflection: Was the English Civil War a true revolution that gave power to the people, or just a transfer of power from the King to wealthy Parliamentarians? [p. 29]

Q10. How did the English Civil War and the execution of Charles I change the balance of power?

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Teacher Comment:

L5: Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze why **King [Key Individual: King [Key Individual: King Charles I]]** and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651).
- ☐ Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth.
- ☐ Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What was the name of the first permanent English settlement in North America (1607)?

2. Which cash crop saved the Jamestown colony from economic ruin?

3. What type of business model was the East India Company (EIC), where multiple investors pooled money?

4. Which powerful Asian empire did Sir Thomas Roe visit in 1615?

5. Why were the English submissive traders in India, but aggressive conquerors in North America?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Divine Right of Kings | New Model Army | Commonwealth | Plantation | Navigation Acts

Your Sentence:

Q1. How useful is this painting as evidence of Britain's global power and ideology in 1778? [p. 32]

Q2. Based on Source A, how did the visual appearance of London change as it became a global financial hub? [p. 33]

Q3. Look at Source E. What did the design of the 1651 Great Seal signal about Britain's new priorities compared to the previous 600 years? [p. 33]

Q4. How do Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 differ in identifying the true 'winner' of the Civil War? [p. 34]

Q5. Lesson Reflection: Considering the English Civil War and the rise of transatlantic trade, did political ideology or economic ambition play a greater role in shifting the balance of power in Britain? [p. 34]

Q6. Explain how the 'Financial Revolution' (like the Bank of England) helped Britain build a modern empire.

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Teacher Comment:

L6: What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the Triangular Trade and the middle passage.
- ☐ Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1. What is a 'joint-stock company'?

2. What cash crop saved the Jamestown colony from economic failure?

3. Who won the English Civil War (1642-1651)?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **Triangular Trade**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

Q1. How did powerful African empires like the Dahomey acquire people to sell into slavery? [p. 37]

Q2. What goods did European merchants trade in exchange for enslaved people? [p. 37]

Q3. Study Source A. What does the heavy fortification of Cape Coast Castle tell us about the nature of the slave trade? [p. 37]

Q4. Based on Source B (the flowchart), what specific goods were exchanged for enslaved Africans in West Africa? [p. 38]

Q5. What is an 'absentee landlord'? [p. 39]

Q6. Why was the Caribbean sugar system often described as a 'death camp' model? [p. 39]

Q7. Study Source C. Why do you think absentee landlords back in London were able to ignore the brutality shown in illustrations like this? [p. 39]

Q8. UCL Research Task Worksheet: Write down your findings for Task A and B, and write your 150-word summary for Task C here: [p. 40]

Q9. Lesson Reflection: How did the reality of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and the brutal 'death camp' model of the Caribbean sugar plantations challenge the idea that 18th-century Britain was a 'modern', enlightened, and civilized society? [p. 40]

Assessment Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention Bristol/Liverpool, manufactured goods, enslaved people, and sugar/tobacco.
- Sentence Starter: The Triangular Trade enriched Britain through three main stages. Firstly...
- Sentence Starter: Secondly, enslaved Africans were brutally transported to...
- Sentence Starter: Finally, the immense profits from raw materials (like sugar) flowed back into British ports like...

Q10. How did the Triangular Trade directly enrich British port cities?

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Teacher Comment:

L7: How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze primary sources from formerly enslaved Africans.
- ☐ Investigate the Jamaican Maroon Wars.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1. What were the three legs of the Triangular Trade?

2. What was a 'barracoon'?

3. Why was sugar known as a 'killer crop'?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary in Context

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Obeah | Maroons | Covert Resistance

Q1. How does the story of Queen Nanny challenge the traditional historical narrative about the abolition of slavery? [p. 43]

Q2. Give one example of covert resistance and explain why an enslaved person might choose it over overt resistance. [p. 44]

Q3. Inferring Motive (Source B): Why did jumping overboard represent a powerful act of resistance for enslaved Africans, even though it resulted in death? [p. 45]

Q4. Evaluating Significance (Equiano's Portrait & Source A): Why was Equiano's autobiography so historically revolutionary when published in London in 1789? [p. 45]

Q5. Based on Source D, why did the Stono Rebellion terrify the British planter class, and what was the immediate goal of the rebels? [p. 46]

Q6. What was the long-term consequence of the rebellion for enslaved people in South Carolina? [p. 46]

Q7. What is the 'White Savior Narrative' in the context of the slave trade? [p. 47]

Q8. According to modern historians like Eric Williams, what were the *true* underlying reasons slavery ended? [p. 47]

Q9. Lesson Reflection: Why is it historically inaccurate and damaging to claim that the abolition of the slave trade was purely the result of benevolent white politicians like William Wilberforce? [p. 47]

Q10. Why might psychological and chemical resistance have been just as effective as armed rebellion? [p. 47]

Q11. Explain how the Jamaican Maroons successfully resisted British control.

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General Notes

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Teacher Comment:

L8: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state in the context of 18th-century Europe.
- ☐ Synthesise domestic social realities with imperial/commercial expansion across the period 1450–1750.
- ☐ Construct a high-level, structured synoptic essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the primary function of the 1607 Jamestown Fort design?

2. Why did Oliver Cromwell execute King Charles I in 1649?

3. What was the strategic advantage of the Jamaican Maroons' location?

4. What motivated the creation of the Royal African Company?

Vocabulary Check

Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Modernity | Synoptic | National Debt | Rotten Borough | The Bloody Code

Your Sentence:

Q1. Study Source A. How does this painting glorify the British Empire while masking the brutal realities of colonization? [p. 51]

Q2. Based on Source B (Weighing the Evidence toggle tabs), identify one piece of political evidence that proves Britain was modern, and one piece of political evidence proving it was un-modern. [p. 53]

Q3. Reconciling Contradictions: How can Source C and Source D offer completely opposite views of Britain in the late 1740s/1750s without either author necessarily lying? [p. 53]

Q4. Synthesis Challenge: Combine the insights from Sources C and D with your knowledge of the Atlantic Slave Trade to write a nuanced 3-sentence summary of British society in 1750. [p. 53]

Q5. Map these historical realities onto the spectrum below to plan your argument. [p. 55]

Q6. Lesson Reflection: Synthesizing everything you have learned in this unit, which development between 1450 and 1750 had the most profound impact on shaping the 'modern' world we live in today? [p. 55]

Synoptic Assessment

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Intro: Define modernity and state your overall argument (it was modern economically, but traditional socially).
- Para 1 (Modern): Discuss the Financial Revolution, Bank of England, and global trade (East India Company).
- Para 2 (Traditional): Discuss the brutal social realities (The Bloody Code, chattel slavery, Mudlarks).
- Conclusion: Summarise your judgment. Was the modernity just an illusion for the rich?

Q7. How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?

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Teacher Comment:

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